Name: PRANJAL SWARUP BHATNAGAR **Reg. No.:** RA2512703010007
Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 2 : Session – 2 | Needs of the Self and the Body

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. Need of the Self vs the Body — WHAT it is: happiness, respect, trust (Self) vs food, shelter, clothing (Body). IN TIME: continuous (Self) vs temporary (Body). IN QUANTITY: qualitative/not quantifiable (Self) vs quantitative and limited (Body). FULFILLED BY: right understanding and right feeling (Self) vs physico-chemical things/physical facility (Body). Mixing the two — trying to fill a continuous, qualitative need with temporary, quantitative things — is the root of dissatisfaction.
2. Q2. 'Need of consciousness cannot be fulfilled by material; need of material is fulfilled by material.' FOOD/TASTE example: hunger (body's need) is fulfilled by food — material fulfils material. But the wish for TASTE beyond hunger, or the wish to be LIKED while eating together, is of the Self — no quantity of food satisfies it. RESPECT example: respect is a feeling-need of the Self; gifts, cars or posts cannot buy the feeling of being respected — only right evaluation and relationship fulfil it. Conversely, using feelings to fix a broken leg is equally futile. Each order of need must be met by its own order of fulfilment.
3. Q3. The GROSS MISUNDERSTANDING: 'human being = the Body'. From it follow the errors: needs = only physical facility; happiness = pleasant sensations; respect = possessions; continuity = unlimited accumulation. It LEADS TO: unlimited want, deprivation despite abundance, exploitation of other humans, and degradation of nature — individually stress and meaninglessness; collectively consumerism, conflict and ecological crisis. Correcting it — seeing the human as co-existence of Self and Body — realigns needs, priorities and effort.
4. Q4. Examining my own list of desires (gadgets, marks, clothes, appreciation, friendship, career...): marking each as need of Self or Body, I find the MAJORITY are needs of the Self — to be appreciated, trusted, understood, happy. Yet my daily EFFORT is mostly spent on body-related and facility-related pursuits. CONCLUSION: my effort is misallocated; continuous happiness requires investing in right understanding and right feelings, with only the required, limited effort for physical facility.